

UNIT 47



URBAN LIFE

CONVERSATION

Sam: Man, this rain is nuts.

Nina: I know! The whole street looked like a river. The storm drains don't stand a chance—water's just piling up everywhere.

Sam: I saw a city crew messing with a manhole earlier. Honestly, looked pointless.

Nina: Yeah, poor guys. Nothing they do right now is gonna stop it from backing up.

Sam: And the potholes? Forget it—way worse after this storm.

Nina: Don't remind me. I hit one by the corner and thought my tyre was done for.

Sam: Crazy, right? And the sidewalks are a slip-and-slide. I nearly face-planted twice.

Nina: Not only is this whole situation dangerous, but it's also so stressful. My sneakers are soaked, and now I gotta sit in damp shoes all day at work. Total nightmare.

Sam: Classic city life—streets falling apart, nobody fixing them. The City Council really dropped the ball on this one.

Nina: True. At least the rain cleared some of the smog out of the air.

Sam: Yeah, small win... but feels like no one's ever really gonna fix this mess.

Nina: Exactly. You just kinda learn to live with it, even though it sucks.



VOCABULARY



Manhole



Storm drain



Pothole



Street gutter



Pollution



Smog



Litter



Traffic
congestion

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

Countable



Uncountable



UNIT 47



URBAN LIFE

EXERCISE 1

Use **much** or **many**.

- A. There isn't much litter on the streets today.
- B. There are _____ potholes on this road; be careful!
- C. How _____ traffic is there during the morning rush hour?
- D. There isn't _____ fog this morning, so driving is easy.
- E. There are _____ street gutters blocked with leaves and trash.
- F. There isn't _____ pollution in the small town.
- G. How _____ manholes can you see on this avenue?

EXERCISE 2

Complete the sentences using **much** or **many** and **the vocabulary**:

litter, traffic, pollution, fog, street gutter, pothole, storm drain, manhole

- A. There is much litter _____ by the park.
- B. _____ near the avenue I pass by.
- C. _____ downtown.
- D. _____ in front of work.
- E. _____ on the main avenue.
- F. _____ near my house.
- G. _____ in the city.

SUMMARY

Words	Possibility of counting	Example
Litter, traffic congestion, pollution, smog	Uncountable	There is much smog in the city. There is much litter near the park.
Street gutter, pothole, storm drain, manhole	Countable	There are many potholes on this road. There are many manholes along the avenue.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. much
- B. many
- C. much
- D. much
- E. many
- F. much
- G. many

Exercise 2

Answers vary.